

Module – 04**Business reports**

Business Reports: Purpose, Kinds and Objectives of reports , Organization & Preparing reports, short and long reports Writing Proposals: Structure & preparation , Writing memos, Media Management: The press release, Press conference, Media interviews. Group Communication: Meetings, Planning meetings, objectives , participants , timing , venue of meetings. Meeting Documentation: Notice, Agenda and Resolution & Minutes.

Writing Reports

- A Report is a logical and systematic presentation of facts and information related to a specific topic.
- A report can be defined as a communication in which the writer gives information to some individual or organization because it is his or her responsibility to do so.
- It is an assigned communication for a purpose & for a specific receiver/ reader.
- A written statement of the facts of a situation, a project, a process or a test; how these facts were ascertained; their significance; the conclusions that have been drawn from them; the recommendations that are being made.

Purpose of report writing

- To give information about company's activities.
- To record events for future references in DM.
- To recommend specific action.
- To justify & persuade readers about the need for action in controversial action.
- To present facts to the management to help decide the direction the business should choose.

Objectives of Reports

- Measuring effective performances.
- Help in combating changes.
- Provides information.
- Controlling of activities.
- Helps in coordination.
- Contact with customers.
- Record keeping.
- Recommends action.

Essentials of good report/ Characteristics

- Accuracy

- Simplicity
- Completeness
- Brevity
- Appearance
- Readability
- Reliability
- Economy
- Timelines
- Logical content

General guidelines in writing a report

- Purpose
- Organizing
- Scheduling
- Cost
- Accuracy
- Communication
- Short but clear
- Language
- Routine nature
- Paragraphs
- Concise
- Recommendations
- Signature & date.

Kinds of reports

- Formal reports: contains all essential elements of report/ prescribed format.
- Semi formal/ informal reports: do not have any uniform structure.
- Routine reports: made by filling in a printed form.
- Letter reports: in the form of letters.
- Memo reports: in the form of memos.
- Progress reports: progress & status of the project.
- Periodic reports.
- Laboratory reports.
- Technical reports.
- Marketing reports.
- accounting reports.
- Production reports., etc....

Steps in writing/ preparing reports

1. Investigating the sources of information
2. Taking notes
3. Analyzing the data
4. Making an outline
5. Writing the report

Elements/ Parts of a report- Short & Long term

- Cover
- Title page
- Acknowledgement
- Table of contents.
- Executive summary.
- Introduction: Objectives & Methodology
- Body of the report: A literature review, Methods, discussions/ Description.
- Conclusion
- Recommendations
- Appendices
- Bibliography
- Glossary
- Index

Basic & Subsidiary Parts

The basic Parts

- Executive summary
- Introduction
- Discussion
- Recommendation
- appendix

The subsidiary Parts

- Cover
- Title page
- Table of contents
- Bibliography/ references
- Glossary

Organizing a report

There are three ways in which report can be analyzed.

1. Letter form: Contains Introduction, Findings, Recommendations.
2. Memorandum form.
3. Letter text combination form: Contains introductory parts, body of the reports, appendix.

Writing a proposal

- A proposal is the presentation of an idea that you wish to pursue.
- A good proposal presumes that you have already thought about your project and have devoted some time and effort in gathering information, reading, and then organizing your thoughts.
- **A proposal is NOT a project to be thrown together in one night with ideas off the top of your head.** Thus, one might say that the research proposal is a second step, following the selection of a broad topic.
- The actual proposal will indicate what analytical question you wish to address. The foundation of a good research paper is a good research question. Just a tree needs a good root system to grow to be strong, a good research paper needs a good analytical question.

The specific parts of the proposal are as follows:

1. Statement of the question your paper will answer. Again, remember, the point of your paper is to explain something.
2. Brief literature review in which you review the major works on your topic and indicate what the arguments are. If you are applying a theory to an issue, you can review the theory used. The point is to show an awareness of what has been written on your issue, what evidence was used, what theories applied, and what arguments were made.
3. A statement as to what your argument/explanation will be.
4. A statement as to how your explanation/argument will differ from that which has been made by other authors. How is your explanation original or different? If you applying a theory, you can explain which theory you will use and why you think that is the appropriate theory to explain the event(s) you are interested in.
5. A brief outline of the parts of the paper.
6. A short bibliography/statement as to the major sources you will use. This can include databases, websites, interviews, etc.
7. The proposal need not be long, but the quality should be high. I would think that 3-4 pages would be sufficient. The more effort you put into your proposal the better your paper will be. Also, the more detailed your proposal, the more I can comment and usefully guide you to a good paper.
8. You should have a proposal prepared and submitted to me No Later than one month after class begins. Start early; the earlier the better.
9. A proposal which does not follow directions is liable to be returned to you for you to re-do.

How to Write a Project Proposal

- Title page

- Project title
- Contents page
- Abstract
- Context
- Project justification/aim
- Target group
- Project implementation
- Budget
- Monitoring and evaluation
- Reporting
- Management and personnel
- Annexures

Memo Format

Memo has two subjects

- ▶ **The heading**
- ▶ **the body**

A Memo format may be vertical or horizontal

In the **vertical format** all the lines of formal information begin at the left margin

Date:

To:

From:

Subject:

In the **horizontal format**, the “To” and “From” lines at the left margin, while the “Date” and “Subject” are at the right

To:

Date:

From:

Subject:

Drafting a Memo

- A well-written memo is **informative and concise**
- Informative by the **principles of preparation and organization**

- **Preparation:** decide the exact objective
- **Organization of content:** it can be organized by decreasing order of importance or increasing the order of importance

Memo Style

- A Memo is always **brief**
- **Be cordial, straight ward, lucid** but formal
- **Use caution in negative situations** too much technical jargon or complicated sentences are not suitable for any business communication

Media Management

- Press Release
- Press Conference
- Media Interviews

Press Release

- The writer is often filled with a sense of the importance of his own news.
- The immediate audience of the message contained in the press release is the editor or a reporter.
- It is important to bear in mind that newspaper offices, radio and TV stations receive hundreds of press releases everyday .

Purpose of the Press Release:

- Award announcement.
- Opening of a social service project.
- International participants tie-up.
- New product or publication available.
- A new high level appointment in the organization.
- Shareholders' meeting notice.
- Visits of important persons either from the country or from aboard.
- Any land mark event such as jubilee.

Audience Response

- What do you want the readers of the news to do?
- Factual Details: you must have full information on the six basics of news:
 1. **Who**
 2. **What**
 3. **Where**

4. **Why**
5. **Whom**
6. **How**

7 Rules for Perfect Press Releases

- Decide Who and Why Before What
- Write A Great Headline
- Keep it Brief
- Provide Valuable Content
- Include Sharable Content
- Make it Search Engine Friendly (but don't go crazy)
- Make it Worth Talking about

Press Check List

- Company letterhead, Name, Address, Phone number, Web site address
- PRESS RELEASE in all caps, bold
- Contact person's name, telephone and mobile numbers, e mail address
- Immediate release or release date
- Headline or title in bold
- Body-city, date-who, what, when, where and why and how
- Sum it up
- Basic font, double-spaced, page numbers

Company's Letterhead

Press Release

For Immediate Release

Headline

Sub-heading

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About Company

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Contact For Furthur Information

Name:

Address:

Phone:

E-mail:

Website:

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[COMPANY LOGO]

Contact: John Smith
Tel. 555/555-2222
Cell Phone: 555/555-2222
Email: johnsmith@anywhere.com

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE

MAIN TITLE OF PRESS RELEASE GOES HERE IN ALL UPPER CASE
Subtitle Goes Here in Title Case (Upper and Lower)

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If you'd like more information about this topic, or to schedule an interview with John Smith, please
call Pat Brown at 555/555-2222 or e-mail Pat at pr@theplace4vitamins.com

Contact: John Smith
Tel. 555/555-2222
Cell Phone: 555/555-2222
Email: johnsmith@anywhere.com

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Press Conference

Introduction

- A press is held on the initiative of the organization.
- It is voluntary presentation of information to the media.
- It is the event hosted by the organization.

Preparing for the Press Conference

- Announcing the opening of an important new venture.
- Attracting more people to be interested and involved in your organization's activity.
- Demonstrating the strength of your organization.
- Getting publicity for your efforts and or problems.
- Getting widespread media coverage for your organization and its activities.
- Informing the media and the public about your side of a story which has been circulating widely.
- Sending a message to is decision-maker about a need.
- Media Interview

Media Interview

- Media Interview
- Media interview may be for the print media or for radio or TV.
- For the radio, tone of voice is of great importance, for the TV, personal appearance, body language, besides tone of voice are important.
- Some time during a TV discussion, a manager from a company may be called upon to intervene by video connection.

Before the interview

- Discuss all interview requests & other media opportunities or public information office in organization.
- Get all the details about the interview (time, live or taped, queries).
- Find out every possible format of the program, style of the publication & about the journalist.
- Develop three to five key messages.
- Anticipate questions & prepare answers ahead of time.
- If possible, make a rehearsal.
- Dress appropriately.
- It is useful to get to the interview location 15 minutes early to feel familiar.
- Be relaxed & focus – help the interview to be effective.

During the Interview

- Begin each answer with most important points.
- It is better not to make any comment which is not to be made public.
- Put life enthusiasm in your answers.
- choose words carefully.
- Use the pause to organize your thoughts.
- Anyone who is high position, must be able to speak fluently.
- Keep your answers brief.
- Wait patiently for the reporter to ask the next question
- Be polite, honest & friendly but maintain a professional tone
- Emphasize what you say.
- Never lose your cool nature.
- Always remember you are representing your organization.
- Mention your company's name frequently.
- Maintain eye contact with the reporter/ interviewer.
- Avoid nodding your head.
- Be enthusiastic & use the opportunity to convey your message.
- At the end, thank the interviewer.

After the interview

- Follow up promptly with the additional information that you m have promised.
- Ask the reporter when the story will appear.
- Thank the reporter for featuring the program.

GROUP COMMUNICATION

Group: Three or more individuals who interact over time, depend on each other, and follow shared rules of conduct in order to reach a common goal.

Ideal size: 4-7

Team: Special type of group characterized by different and complementary resources of members and a strong sense of collective identity.

Factors that affect Group Communication

1. Cohesion
2. Group Size
3. Power Relationships
4. Interaction Patterns

- a) Chain
- b) Wheel
- b) All-Channel
- 5. Group Norms: Rules v. Norms
- 6. Cultural Differences
- 7. Leadership Styles: Democratic, Autocratic, Laissez Faire

Meetings

Introduction

- Meetings are the commonest corporate ritual everywhere.
- Thirty to fifty percent of a senior manager's time is spent meeting.
- From the most junior to the CEO, everyone has to spend time in meeting.
- People consider the meeting as waste of time or as opportunity to take time off.
- Work is done by meetings
- It is the meeting that are called for examining problems, proposals, and issues that fail sometimes.
- Many project groups that meet regularly actually produce results such as a design or a model during a meeting
- If the meeting is not conducted well, it is sure to accomplish little & also leave a poor impression on the participants
- Poorly managed meeting.
- Often e mail, messages, telephone calls, or a fax can settle a matter.
- For some issues that need careful deliberations, however, there is no substitute for face to face meeting.
- Every manager needs the skill to plan a meeting & to guide subordinate in making arrangements & in acting as facilitator.

Unproductive, Time-waste Meetings

- Lack of clear objectives
- Interruptions
- Silent participants
- No timely closure
- Too many people
- No agenda or not kept to
- Agenda arrives too late
- Participants not prepared
- Poor time-keeping
- Poor controlled by the chair
- Minutes distributed too long after the meeting

Planning Meetings/ Organizing

- Objectives
- Creating an Agenda
- Topics
- Sequence of Items
- Time
- Circulation
- Participants
- Timing
- Venue

Conducting the Meeting:

- A meeting should run by itself- not be run by the authority figure.
- Once the discussion begins, the leader's role is to observe, listen, facilitate, provide needed information and ensure fair opportunity to every participant.
- Control:
- A meeting brings together people who have information, skills, representative interests and vision.

The Six Most Common Complaints About Meetings

- Getting off the subject by jumping from topic to topic or bringing up irrelevant issues.
- Meeting with no goals or agenda.
- Meetings that run too long (often because they got off to a late start).
- Poor or inadequate preparation by the president and the other members of the officer team.
- Meetings that reach no conclusions or produce no decisions.
- Disorganized meetings, especially those marred by interruptions.

Reasons For Holding The Meetings

- To convey information to a group
- To solicit information from a group
- To answers questions
- To participate in group decision making
- To brainstorm ideas
- To solve problems
- To network
- To sell an idea, product, or service
- To show or provide support for others
- To obtain quick reactions.
- To Accept the reports from participants.

- To Reach group judgments.

Types of Meetings

- **Quick business meetings** (just to check-in, coordinate, share info, prepare for next steps, anticipate customer or employee needs, answer questions for each other, etc.)
- **“Stand-up” meetings** (no more than 10 minutes to plan the day, make announcements, set expectations, assure understanding and alignment, identify upcoming difficulties, etc.)
- **Business meetings** (with customers, clients, colleagues, etc.; often require presentations.)
- **Staff meetings** (to clear calendars, coordinate unit activities, share info, etc.)
- **Management Team meetings** (to solve problems, make decisions, set policy, etc.)
- **Interdepartmental meetings** (to get input, interpret decisions and policies, share info, etc.)
- **Coordinating meetings** (to assure all know what’s happening when and who is responsible.)
- **Board meetings** (to report results, set policies and directions, scan for needed changes, etc.)
- **Team building meetings** (to communicate together, resolve conflicts, share impressions and feelings, gain alignment and commitment to goals, strengthen relationships, clear out debris from disputes, develop or deepen interpersonal trust, etc.)
- **Project Team meetings** (to define results, methods, schedules, responsibilities, policies, etc.)
- **Creative product development meetings** (to define new markets, create new products, etc.)
- **Community meetings** (to interpret decisions, get input, build relationships, gain trust, etc.)
- **Conferences and Retreats** (to share information, work through strategies and tactics, involve people, set long-range directions, work in sub-groups as well as in total group, etc.)

Meeting Documentation

- Notice,
- Agenda,
- Resolution & Minutes.

3 Components of a Business Meeting: Notice, Agenda and Minutes

Notice of a Meeting:

- When a meeting is to be convened, a notice is required to be sent to all who are to attend it.

It should satisfy these conditions:

- a) It should be under proper authority
- b) It should state the name of the organisation
- c) It should state the day, date, time, and place. Also, sometimes, how to reach the place
- d) It should be well in advance. Some require seven days’ notice, some 48 hours’
- e) It should state the purpose and, if possible, the agenda
- f) It should carry the date of circulation and convener’s/secretary’s signature

- g) It should go to all persons required at the meet
- h) It should mention the TA/DA etc. payable and the arrangements for this
- In practice, it is necessary to ensure that the notice has reached in time. This may be done telephonically. Dispatch section and post are prone to delays
- We often find that between the date of a letter from a major public organisation and the post mark on the letter, there is a gap of 10-12 days. A notice that should reach seven days before a meet should not reach seven days after the meet.

Specimen notices**1.**

Seven Hills Housing Cooperative Society
Sundar Nagar, New Delhi

NOTICE OF MEETING

11th September 2011

The 44th meeting of the Executive Committee will be held at 8.00 p.m. on Sunday, 22nd September 2011 in Sanket Auditorium. The agenda is given below.

- 44.01 Minutes of the previous meeting
- 44.02 Appointment of a new watchman
- 44.03 Celebration of Kojagiri
- 44.04 Donations for flood relief
- 44.05 Permission to sell flat
- 44.06 Defaulting members
- 44.07 Purchase of a generator
- 44.08 Any other matter with the permission of the Chair.

You are requested to attend the meet.

Rajnath Mistry
Executive Secretary

cc: To all members

2.

Itwari Kirana Dealers Association
Resham Oli, Nagpur

NOTICE OF MEETING

To: All members

Notice is hereby given that the Annual General Meeting of the members of IKDA is scheduled to be held on 1st November, 2011 at 4.40 p.m. at Hotel India Sun, Central Avenue to consider the following business:

- To receive and adopt the Income and Expenditure Account, Balance Sheet, and Report of the Auditors for the year ended Diwali 2011.
- To elect President, Vice President, Honorary Secretary, Treasurer and Executive Committee Members for the current year.
- To prepare a representation to the NMC* about the actions of the Anti-Encroachment Squad.
- To discuss any other matter for which at least SEVEN days' advance notice is given and which is approved by the Chair.

By order of the Executive Committee

Nagpur
20th October 2011

Arun Maloo
Honorary Secretary

*Nagour Municipal Corporation

Minutes of the Meeting:

- The minutes of a meeting are the record of the discussions/decisions therein. They have an official status; they are useful in law, and in some cases required by law to be written. Minutes are final when they are approved by the members of the group to which they relate, generally in the next meeting, and signed by the chairperson.

- Even if there are emotional moments in a meet, the minutes are written in an unemotional manner, are cool, factual, impersonal, and impartial. Moreover, such are the demands of time on most people that the minutes should be concise, boiled down to the essentials.
- Only some organizations' require that they record the detailed discussions as well (i.e. who said what and what were the reactions... until the decision was reached). Normally, the body of the minute's records.
 - (a) The motions and amendments thereto
 - (b) The proposer and seconded of motions
 - (c) The details of voting, if any
 - (d) Recommendations
 - (e) Decisions/ resolutions
 - (f) Tasks assigned to individuals, sub-committees
- **The overall minutes should give:**
 1. The name of the organisation/ unit
 2. Day, date, time and place
 3. Number in order (e.g. 33rd meeting of...)
 4. Names of chairperson and secretary
 5. Names of members present
 6. Names of the absent
 7. Attendees by special invitation, e.g. auditor, caterer, etc.
 8. Record of the transactions (on the guidelines given above)
 9. Signature of secretary and, after approval, that of the chairman.

Tips for writing minutes:

- The minutes are written generally by the secretary from the notes taken during the meet. He/she can use the agenda as the framework for writing them and use short forms, shorthand etc. to take quick and accurate notes. He may have to ask members to repeat their words to get them right.
- He should note down all the particulars needed for the fair copy of minutes. The items of the minutes can be written under short headings such as are used in the agenda.
- (As for reading them, some committees circulate them in advance and take them as read. Otherwise the reader should read them loudly, clearly, and quickly.)
- **Style wise, they use one of these constructions:**
 - a. It was resolved that the minutes of the previous meeting be approved.

- b. It was decided that a sub-committee be set up to consider
- c. Resolved that a blood donation camp be held on 15th August. (The verb is used in the subjunctive mood: “be done, be appointed”, etc.)
- **Alternatively, the description is given in the past tense:**
- **1. Minutes of last meet:**
- The secretary read out the minutes of the meet dated... and they were approved.
- **2. Donation received:**
- The chairman informed that he had received a donation of Rs. 50,000 from ex-member Mr. Gopal Rathi.
- At the time of approval, the chairman asks, “Do you accept the minutes as they stand?” OR “Any matters arising out of the minutes?”
- Your ability to write good minutes can earn you a prize position in an organisation. Also, if you hold a position and do not know how to write minutes, you may face embarrassment.

Specimen minutes

Archana Literary Society, New Delhi Minutes of Meeting dated 1 st August 1999	
Place and Time of Meeting	Residence of President Dr. Mansha Khan at A-12 Connaught Circus, 3.10 p.m.
Roll Call	Members present: Dr. Mansha Khan (Chairman) Mrs. Padma Raut Col. Devrajan (Secretary) Ms. Dilnawaz Kantawala Mr. Bharatendu Jain Mr. Prabhat Kumar Khatri Mr. Amrit Bose Mrs. Amrita Bose
Members absent :	Dr. Rajan Chhabra
Approval of Minutes of the Last Meeting	The minutes of the meeting dated 25 th June were read by the secretary and confirmed.
Treasurer's Report	The treasurer Mr. B. Jain, circulated his report of the earnings and outgoings of the fete held on 10 th July, which was accepted.
Briefing for All-India Poetry Meet	The President Dr Mansha Khan briefed the members about their roles in the forthcoming All India Poetry Meet at the Red Fort on 26 th January 2000.
Induction of New Members	The membership applications of four applicants – Dr. D. K. Dawani Ms. Snehlata Sharma Mr. L. K. Gosai and Mrs. Geeta Hariwanshi were accepted. The application of Prof. F.F.Guha was held in abeyance owing to invalid recommendation.
Sub-committee for Publication Unit	A sub-committee of three members – Mr. Devrajan Mr. Amrit Bose Mrs. Amrita Bose was set up for launching a publication unit.
Date of Next Meeting	The next meeting was scheduled for 15 th September.
Col. Devrajan Secretary	
